

NIKITA PAVLOV

403 Kern, Department of Economics, Penn State University, State College, PA 16801, USA

Phone: +1-814-699-1940 ♦ E-mail: nmp5624@psu.edu ♦ Homepage: nmp5624.github.io

SUMMARY

I am a fifth-year Ph.D. student in Economics at Penn State University with strong research interests in structural labor economics and theoretical econometrics. Currently I'm mostly programming in Julia, but I'm also familiar with Python, SQL, R and Matlab through past work experience, projects and coursework. Prior to my Ph.D. enrollment, I gained rich and diverse experience as an instructor at my home university and as an analyst.

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics The Pennsylvania State University, USA. GPA: 3.8/4.0	2021 - Present
M.S. in Economics Higher School of Economics University, Russia.	2017 - 2019
B.A. in Management Higher School of Economics University, Russia.	2013 - 2017

RESEARCH INTERESTS

- Labor Economics
 - Household decision making, child human capital formation.
- Theoretical Econometrics
 - Design of optimal statistical treatment assignment rules, empirical process theory.

EMPLOYMENT

Graduate Research Assistant , <i>Department of Economics</i> , Penn State, US	2022 - 2024
• Professor Ewout Verriest, Summer 2024 & 2025 – Designed a structural model linking parenting styles to children's adult outcomes, with individual characteristics as moderators; – Co-authored the paper "<i>Household Transfers and Child Development: Effects on Cognitive and Non-Cognitive Skill Formation</i>". • Professor Patrik Guggenberger, Summer 2022 & 2023 – Co-authored the paper "<i>Minimax regret treatment rules with finite samples when a quantile is the object of interest</i>".	
Analyst , Central Universal Department Store (TsUM), Russia	2020 - 2021
– Analyzed detailed sales and customer data to assess the efficiency of existing targeted discount programs; – Participated in modeling and initialization of SQL database for the store website.	
Assistant , <i>Department of Theoretical Economics</i> , Higher School of Economics, Russia	2018 - 2021
– Taught Economics courses at both undergraduate and graduate levels; – Received the "<i>Best Teacher of the Higher School of Economics University 2021</i>" award.	

Please visit my website at nmp5624.github.io for the most recent versions of my working papers.

"Child Cognitive and Mental Development under Parental Threat of Corporal Punishment"

Prospective Job Market Paper

Abstract: I develop and estimate a dynamic model of child human capital formation that embeds parents' option to implement a corporal-punishment (CP) scheme within the household's intertemporal time budget and labor-supply problem. Parents allocate time budget across productive time with the child, leisure, and market work; the child acts as a Stackelberg follower, allocating time to self-investment, regular leisure, and non-compliant leisure (misbehavior). If adopted, the CP scheme governs realized punishment via a Poisson process whose intensity is proportional to non-compliant leisure. The scheme deters misbehavior but can harm the child's cognitive capital and mental stability capital — two age-dependent, interrelated human-capital dimensions that enter both the parents' and the child's utilities. As an alternative to CP, parents can discourage misbehavior by spending more time with the child, thereby tightening the child's time budget; this comes at the cost of foregone leisure and work hours, creating a non-trivial parenting-style trade-off. The model allows for rich heterogeneity in parental and child preferences and in labor-market opportunities across households, addressing selection on both sides. I estimate the model by the Method of Simulated Moments using the PSID (1986–2007) dataset. Counterfactual bans of CP indicate average gains of 0.12σ in final mental-stability capital among previously exposed children, rising to 0.20σ for those who also received physical punishment. The ban reduces mothers' labor-force participation by 4% and, among stayers, cuts median hours by 14%, lowering median household income by 3.8%; fathers' participation changes are negligible. Effects on cognitive capital are heterogeneous and often ambiguous, reflecting offsets between the ban's direct benefits and indirect losses from reduced child self-investment and household income. Policy implications favor pairing CP restrictions with supports that preserve parental time and earnings.

"Minimax regret treatment rules with finite samples when a quantile is the object of interest"

*with Patrik Guggenberger and Nihal Mehta. *R&R in Econometric Theory*.*

Abstract: Consider the setup in which a policymaker is informed about the population by a finite sample and based on that sample has to decide whether or not to apply a certain treatment to the population. We work out finite sample minimax regret treatment rules under various sampling schemes when outcomes are restricted onto the unit interval. In contrast to Stoye (2009) where the focus is on maximization of expected utility the focus here is instead on a particular quantile of the outcome distribution. We find that in the case where the sample consists of a fixed number of untreated and a fixed number of treated units, any treatment rule is minimax regret optimal. The same is true in the case of random treatment assignment in the sample with any assignment probability and in the case of testing an innovation when the known quantile of the untreated population equals $1/2$. However if the known quantile exceeds $1/2$ then never treating is the unique optimal rule and if it is smaller than $1/2$ always treating is optimal. We also consider the case where a covariate is included.

"Household Transfers and Child Development: Effects on Cognitive and Non-Cognitive Skill Formation"

with Ewout Verriest.

Abstract: Using the DFVW (2025) dynamic model of child human-capital formation, we compare transfer designs and their effects on children's cognitive and non-cognitive skills. We contrast restricted transfers that must be spent on child-specific consumption with unrestricted cash given to parents, under both conditional and unconditional regimes. Across both regimes, restricted transfers yield larger gains in cognitive skills than unrestricted cash. However, these gains can come at a cost to non-cognitive skills when policies introduce strong extrinsic incentives that, in the model, depress the child's effective discount factor and crowd out intrinsic motivation. Counterfactual simulations delineate when restricted transfers and conditionality raise cognitive achievement without eroding non-cognitive development, and inform policy design that balances improvements in cognition with the preservation of socio-emotional skills.

TEACHING

As Instructor (Higher School of Economics University):

- 2020/2021:
Advanced Macroeconomics (Master's programme; Faculty of Economic Sciences), Fall 2020;
Macroeconomics 2 (Bachelor's programme; Faculty of World Economy and International Affairs), Fall 2020;
Economics (Bachelor's programme; Faculty of Communications, Media, and Design), Spring 2021;
Economics (Bachelor's programme; Faculty of Humanities), Spring 2021.
- 2019/2020:
Advanced Macroeconomics (Master's programme; Faculty of Economic Sciences), Fall 2019;
Macroeconomics (Bachelor's programme; Graduate School of Business), Spring 2020;
Macroeconomics 1 (Bachelor's programme; Faculty of Economic Sciences), Spring 2020.
- 2018/2019:
Research Seminar "Economic Thinking" (Bachelor's programme; Faculty of Economic Sciences), Fall 2018;
Macroeconomics (Minor; Faculty of Economic Sciences), Spring 2019.

As Graduate Teaching Assistant (Penn State University):

- Environmental Economics (ECON 428, undergraduate), Fall 2024 & 2025;
- Advanced Macroeconomics (ECON 522, graduate), Spring 2025;
- Economics of Public Expenditures (ECON 425, undergraduate), Spring 2024;
- Monetary Theory and Policy (ECON 451, undergraduate), Fall 2022 & 2023;
- Corporate Economics (ECON 444, undergraduate), Spring 2023.

OTHER INFORMATION

Visa Status:	F-1;
Citizenship:	Russian Federation;
Languages:	English (fluent), Russian (native);
Computer Skills:	Julia, R, Python, MATLAB, SQL, L ^A T _E X, MS Office.